

Marcus R. Ellison

Senior Software Engineer • Backend & Distributed Systems

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Results-driven Senior Software Engineer with 9+ years of experience designing and operating large-scale distributed systems. Deep expertise in Go, Java, and Kubernetes-based cloud infrastructure. Led multiple platform re-architectures that reduced system latency by 40–60% and cut cloud costs by millions annually. Passionate about engineering culture, mentoring, and building resilient software.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages:

Go, Java, Python, TypeScript, Rust (working knowledge)

Frameworks & Tools:

gRPC, Kafka, Redis, PostgreSQL, Elasticsearch, GraphQL, React

Infrastructure:

Kubernetes, Helm, Terraform, AWS (EKS, RDS, S3, Lambda), GCP, Docker, Istio, Prometheus/Grafana

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer II | *Stratum Systems, Inc.* Mar 2021 – Present • San Francisco, CA

- Tech lead for the Payments Platform team (7 engineers), driving quarterly roadmap planning and cross-team API design reviews.
- Re-designed the transaction processing pipeline using event-driven architecture (Kafka + Go consumers), reducing average end-to-end latency from 340 ms to 92 ms.
- Implemented distributed tracing across 18 microservices using OpenTelemetry, improving MTTR from 47 min to 11 min.
- Mentored 3 junior engineers through structured 1-on-1s and code review; two were promoted within 18 months.
- Introduced internal developer platform tooling (custom Helm charts + Terraform modules) that cut new service bootstrap time from 3 days to under 2 hours.
- Collaborated with Security team to integrate OPA-based policy enforcement at the API gateway layer, passing SOC 2 Type II audit.

Software Engineer | *Helios Cloud* Jul 2018 – Feb 2021 • Austin, TX

- Built real-time analytics ingestion pipeline (1.2 M events/sec) using Apache Kafka and Apache Flink on AWS EMR.
- Migrated monolithic Java codebase to 11 domain-bounded microservices, enabling independent deployments and reducing release cycle from 6 weeks to 2 weeks.
- Led performance optimisation sprint that improved 99th-percentile API response time from 2.4 s to 310 ms (PostgreSQL query tuning + Redis caching layer).
- Contributed to internal open-source SDK for AWS Lambda observability — 2,800+ GitHub stars.

Software Engineer | *PixelLoop Media* Aug 2015 – Jun 2018 • New York, NY

- Developed backend services for a video transcoding platform processing 500 TB/month using FFmpeg and AWS S3/CloudFront.
- Designed and launched REST + GraphQL API consumed by web and mobile clients (5 M+ registered users).
- Introduced CI/CD pipelines (Jenkins → GitHub Actions) reducing deployment failures by 65%.

EDUCATION

B.Sc. Computer Science | [University of Michigan](#) 2011 – 2015 • Ann Arbor, MI
GPA: 3.8 / 4.0 • Specialisation: Systems & Networks • Dean's List (4 semesters)

CERTIFICATIONS & AWARDS

- Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) — CNCF, 2022
- AWS Certified Solutions Architect — Professional, 2021
- Stratum Systems Engineering Excellence Award, Q3 2022 & Q1 2024
- Speaker: GopherCon 2023 — 'Building Zero-Downtime Pipelines with Kafka and Go'